

- **Sniffing and spoofing:** These tools sniff the network and Web traffic.
 - **Maintaining access:** These tools maintain access to the target machine, to assess operating system back doors and for tunnelling.
 - **Reporting tools:** These document the penetration testing process.
 - **System services:** These tools contain various pen-testing services like Apache, MySQL, SSH and Metasploit services.
- Kali Linux is bundled with several tools that perform wireless attacks, reverse engineering, stress testing, hardware hacking and forensics.

Key features:

- Bundled with more than 600 penetration testing tools as compared to Backtrack OS.
- Completely free and open source and committed to GitHub, with the source code of each package being available.



Figure 1: Kali Linux

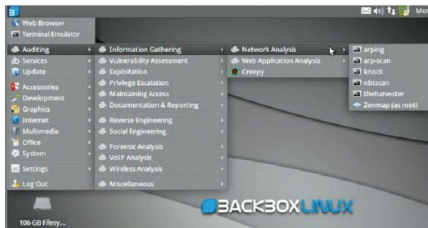


Figure 2: BackBox Linux

minimal desktop environment. The key advantage of BackBox is that its own software repositories are updated at regular intervals to keep the distribution stable and popular for real-world operations.

The BackBox distribution consists of more than 70 tools for tasks ranging from Web analysis and network analysis to stress testing, sniffing, vulnerability assessment, forensics and exploitation.

Key features:

- BackBox Linux is one of the first platforms supporting the cloud for penetration testing.
- It is fully automated and non-intrusive, with no agents or network configuration changes required to achieve regular automated configuration backups.
- Saves time and eliminates the requirement of tracking individual network devices.
- With support of the XFCE desktop, BackBox is regarded as fast in operations and suitable even for old configuration systems.
- Completely hacker friendly due to the support it receives for creating its own Launchpad PPA and sending the package to developers who, in turn, contribute instantly to BackBox Linux.

Official website: <https://backbox.org/>
Latest version: 4.7

3. Parrot Security Operating System

Parrot Security OS is based on Debian GNU/Linux combined with the Frozenbox OS and Kali Linux to provide ethical hackers the best-in-class experience of penetration and security testing in real-world environments. It is also designed to provide vulnerability assessment and mitigation, computer forensics and anonymous Web browsing, by the Frozenbox team.

Parrot Security OS makes use of Kali repositories for all sorts of package updates and to integrate new tools. It makes use of the MATE desktop environment using the